



City Council Meeting February 3rd 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=c8T6qcuT1lk
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Muncie Common Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: February 3, 2025

Governing Body: Muncie Common Council

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the February 3, 2025 meeting of the Muncie Common Council to order at [00:00:30](#), asking attendees to silence phones and stand for the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - *Present:* Council members including Mr. Green, Mr. Garrett, Mr. Dishman, Mr. McIntosh, Ms. Selie, Mr. Powell, and Mr. Gillian. (Roll call confirmed a full quorum).
 - *Absent:* None noted in the roll call.
 - *Presiding Officer:* Presiding officer/President Mason.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - The Pledge of Allegiance was led by the council and presiding officer [00:00:43](#).

- An invocation was delivered by Councilman McIntosh 00:01:14, which included a moment of silence in comfort of councilman Jerry Dishman's brother.
- In recognition of Black History Month, the presiding officer read a quote from the 44th U.S. President, Barack Obama 00:02:15.
- **Citizens Recognition Award:** Presented by Councilman Garrett to **Isaiah House 117** 00:03:02, a non-profit organization assisting foster children transitioning between foster care and placement housing. Representatives spoke about their recent groundbreaking and upcoming contractor lunch on February 18th 00:09:46. Sarah Goan was announced as the next month's recipient.
- **Black History Essay Contest Winners:** Recognized by Miss Thompson, Dr. Kendra Lowry, and Rhonda Ward 00:12:14. First-place student winners read their essays:
 - *Elementary School Winner:* Helen Fan (Burris Laboratory School) 00:13:07
 - *Middle School Winner:* Avery Coles 00:15:50
 - *High School Winner:* Michaela Gibson (Muncie Central High School) 00:19:18
- **Approval of Minutes:** Minutes from the January 6 meeting were approved as presented following a motion by council person Selie, seconded by council person Powell, and passed via roll call vote 00:24:39.
- **Board & Commission Announcements / Appointments:**
 - Announcement made regarding the Muncie Ethics Commission's first meeting scheduled for Wednesday, February 12th at 6:00 PM 00:26:30.
 - Due to Jim Low's appointment to the Ethics Commission, a vacancy opened on the **Muncie Land Bank** board 00:27:01. Dr. John West was nominated by the council, spoke regarding his 7 years of service and urban planning background 00:28:08, and was appointed unanimously by voice vote 00:30:00.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:30:26 Ordinance 31-24: Annexation Area No. 3 (City-Owned Parcel Near Farmington Neighborhood)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** City Administration / Legal Counsel.
- **Deliberation Summary:** An ordinance annexing certain territory (city-owned parcel near Farmington) into the city of Muncie. Committee reports indicated the Land and Traffic committee met on January 22nd in fact-finding mode but did not take a formal recommendation vote due to late information.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None specific to this parcel.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved via roll call vote (unanimous support across present members) 00:31:42.

00:32:13 Ordinance 32-24: Annexation Area No. 4 (Westminster Village)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** City Administration, Fire Chief Robert Burden, and Local 1348 President Jason Chaen.
- **Deliberation Summary:** An ordinance annexing Westminster Village into city limits. Chief Burden and Union President Jason Chaen explained that primary fire and EMS protection would shift from the distant Gaston Volunteer Fire Department (approx. 16-minute response) to Muncie Fire Station 5/7 (5-minute response). Discussion highlighted that EMS user fees generated by the annexation would help fund and staff a dedicated "Medic 7" unit, drastically reducing call burdens on other city medic units (e.g., Medic 5 and Medic 6). The for-profit/non-profit tax and medical billing dynamics were also reviewed.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** Jason Chaen (Local 1348 President) spoke in strong support, emphasizing the positive human factor and workload relief for firefighters [00:44:02](#).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved via roll call vote [00:49:33](#).

[00:50:03](#) Ordinance 1-25: Flood Plain Management Amendments

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Alan Wisley (Assistant City Attorney) on behalf of Building Commissioner Rawlings.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Periodic update required by FEMA and the Indiana Department of Natural Resources (DNR) to keep Muncie property owners eligible for federal flood plane insurance programs.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved via roll call vote [00:51:32](#).

[00:51:53](#) Ordinance 2-25: Vacation of Public Alley in John J. Perkins Addition

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Alan Wisley representing Avendale United Methodist Church, alongside Church Council Chairman Rapid Waters.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Vacates a public alley running through the church's parking lot (utilized for handicap parking and a wheelchair ramp). All adjacent property owners signed off on the vacation.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved via roll call vote [00:53:28](#).

[00:54:01](#) Ordinance 3-25: Zoning Change from R-4 to BC (West Memorial Drive & South Samson Avenue)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jacob Wagner (Listing Broker for ECI Regional Planning Commission).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Rezones property at the northwest corner of West Memorial Drive and South Samson Avenue from R-4 Residence Zone to BC Community Business Zone to allow building refurbishment for apartments on top and commercial space on the

bottom. Noted that the Metropolitan Planning Commission gave a 7-0 (with 2 absences) favorable recommendation.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:54:42](#).

[00:55:58](#) **Ordinance 4-25: Zoning Change from R-2 to BV (West Williamsburg Boulevard)**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Steve Series (Developer Representative) / Opposing neighborhood residents.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Rezoning request for property on the south side of West Williamsburg Boulevard (385 ft east of North Morrison Road) from R-2 Residential to BV Variety Business Zone to build a gas station and a 4-story hotel. The Metropolitan Planning Commission previously issued an unfavorable 7-0 recommendation. Developer requested a continuance, but council members and multiple neighborhood representatives strongly voiced opposition due to light pollution, noise, intense traffic congestion on Morrison Road, safety risks, and negative impacts on adjacent middle-class residential areas (Robinwood Estates and Eagles Nest).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - **Jim Low** (Robinwood resident) outlined historical zoning requests, severe light/noise pollution, and encroachment concerns [00:09:06](#).
 - **Carrie Milliner** (Eagles Nest Association President) spoke on behalf of 24 families (many elderly residents aged 70<U+2013>98) opposing a 4-story hotel and gas station towering over 1-story condos [00:10:09](#).
 - **Connie Ward** (Eagles Nest resident) highlighted health concerns, circadian rhythm disruptions from light pollution, and wildlife (deer) path disruption [01:06:21](#).
 - **Charles Tuitt** (Robinwood Neighborhood Organization President) cited heavy traffic and inadequate 25-foot buffer zones [01:12:44](#).
 - **David Rof** (Resident) opposed the change [01:15:31](#).
 - **James Glick** (Robinwood Treasurer) urged council members to walk the site and reject incompatible development [01:16:30](#).
 - **Kylen Swackhammer** (Plan Commission) clarified the current zone is R-2, not R-4 [01:18:26](#).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Rejected / Failed with a 9-0 vote (unanimously denied) [01:22:17](#).

[00:42:41](#) **Ordinance 5-25: Parking Regulations (Payment Location and Distribution)**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** City Administration.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The city administration formally requested to withdraw this ordinance.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Withdrawn by request [01:22:58](#).

[00:43:27](#) **Ordinance 6-25: Parking Regulations (Burris Laboratory School Parking)**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chief Nathan Sloan (Muncie Police) and Assistant Principal Ben Miller (Burris Laboratory School).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Codifies and formalizes existing parking permit arrangements for Burris students to park in designated city blue-permit zones without facing tickets, transitioning paperwork processes to electronic means.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved for introduction by voice vote [01:27:27](#).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- [01:30:02](#) **Charles Jameson:** Addressed the council regarding recent political rhetoric surrounding Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI). Argued that DEI is a community strength rather than a weakness, and encouraged the council to pass a resolution affirming inclusion and rejecting hate-based trends.
- [01:33:36](#) **Steve Craig:** Inquired about comments allegedly made by Councilman Green at a neighborhood association meeting regarding neighboring counties potentially transporting homeless populations into Muncie via vans.
- [01:34:42](#) **Yvonne Thompson:** Speaking as the Director of the Muncie Human Rights Commission, updated the council on local efforts supporting immigrant families within school systems, churches, and businesses. She urged that city resources and police funds be spent wisely to maintain Muncie as a welcoming community, emphasizing collaboration with community engagement officers and pro bono immigration attorneys.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** None additional noted.
- **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn made by McIntosh, seconded by Dishman, and approved by voice vote [01:32:30](#). Meeting adjourned.

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